



Brainstorming Essay Ideas

A student asks AI to suggest possible thesis statements and angles before starting to write a paper.

TO AI OR NOT TO AI?

USE CASE CARD

STUDENT EDITION



Debugging Code with AI

A student pastes broken code from a programming assignment into AI and asks it to find and fix the error.

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Summarizing a Long Reading

Facing 60 pages of assigned reading the night before class, a student asks AI to summarize the key points instead of reading it all.

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24/7 Study Buddy for Exams

A student uses an AI chatbot to quiz them and explain concepts at 1am, when no classmate or tutor is available.

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Translating a Foreign-Language Text

A student uses AI to translate an assigned reading in a language class instead of working through it themselves.

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AI Grammar & Style Check

Before submitting an essay, a student runs it through AI to catch grammar mistakes and improve awkward sentences.

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AI-Generated Flashcards

A student uploads their lecture notes and asks AI to turn them into a set of flashcards for exam review.

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AI-Managed Group Project

A student uses AI to split up tasks and build a timeline for a group project, then shares the plan with teammates.

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Step-by-Step Concept Explainer

A student asks AI to explain a difficult math or science concept a different way after not understanding it in class.

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AI-Written First Draft

Short on time, a student asks AI to write a full first draft of an essay, which they plan to edit before turning it in.

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AI Mock Interview Practice

A student practices answering interview questions with an AI tool ahead of a real internship or job interview.

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Fact-Checking a Claim

Before including a statistic in a research paper, a student asks AI to verify whether the claim is accurate and where it comes from.

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AI-Generated Practice Problems

A student asks AI to generate extra practice problems similar to ones from a hard homework set, to build more confidence before a test.

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Using AI During a Timed Test

During a proctored, closed-resource exam, a student secretly opens an AI chatbot on their phone to help answer questions.

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AI Course & Elective Recommendations

A student asks AI which electives to take next semester based on their transcript, interests, and career goals.

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AI-Written Resume & Cover Letter

A student asks AI to write a resume and cover letter for a summer internship application from a short list of experiences.

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AI-Generated Presentation Slides

A student asks AI to design and write the slides for a class presentation, including the speaker notes.

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Turning to AI for Emotional Support

Stressed about grades and feeling like they have no one to talk to, a student starts confiding in an AI chatbot late at night.

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Bias & Discrimination

AI writing and grading tools can be less accurate for students who write in a different dialect, are non-native English speakers, or come from a background underrepresented in the AI's training data.

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Hallucination

AI confidently gives you facts, citations, or explanations that are just wrong — risky if you're using it to research a paper or study for an exam.

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Sycophancy

AI tends to tell you your essay or argument is stronger than it actually is, instead of giving the honest critique that would actually improve it.

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Privacy & Data Exposure

Personal details you type into a chatbot — about your grades, your family, or even your mental health — may be stored or used in ways you don't expect.

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Accountability Gap

If AI gives you wrong information and you use it in an assignment, it's not always clear who's responsible when it goes wrong — you, or the tool.

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The Black Box

AI can't always explain why it gave you a particular answer, which makes it hard to know if you can actually trust — or learn from — what it told you.

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Over-Reliance & De-skilling

Leaning on AI to write your essays or solve your problem sets can mean you never actually build the skill you were supposed to be practicing.

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Loss of Human Trust

A teacher, teammate, or interviewer who suspects your work is mostly AI-written may stop trusting your work altogether — even the parts you wrote yourself.

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Security Vulnerability

AI chatbots can be tricked into giving harmful, inappropriate, or unsafe advice if someone knows how to manipulate them.

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Homogenization

If everyone uses AI to polish their essays the same way, papers across a whole class can start to sound alike — and your own voice can get lost.

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Legal & Regulatory Liability

Submitting AI-generated work as entirely your own can violate your school's academic integrity policy, even if you didn't mean to break a rule.

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Reputational Damage

Getting caught passing off AI work as your own can follow you — affecting a grade, a recommendation, or how a teacher sees you going forward.

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Cognitive Surrender

It's easy to stop thinking something through yourself and just take whatever AI says as the answer — even when it's worth double-checking.

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Environmental Impact

Every AI chat you send runs on a data center that uses real energy and water — a small cost that adds up across millions of students doing the same thing.

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Time & Efficiency

AI can get you through repetitive tasks — formatting citations, catching a typo — faster, leaving more time for the parts that actually require thinking.

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Scale & Reach

A single AI study tool can help you review material in ways that would otherwise require hiring a tutor or finding a study group at the right time.

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24/7 Availability

AI can explain a concept or quiz you at 1am before an exam, when no professor, TA, or classmate is around.

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Personalization

AI can explain the same concept several different ways until one actually clicks — something a single textbook explanation can't do.

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Consistency

AI gives the same quality of explanation every time you ask, without having a bad day or losing patience the way a person might.

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Early Pattern Detection

AI can help you notice patterns in your own quiz mistakes or study habits that you might not catch on your own.

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Augmented Decision-Making

AI can help you think through options — like which courses to take — by laying out information, while you make the actual decision based on what matters to you.

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Cost Reduction

Free or low-cost AI tools can substitute for expensive tutoring or paid study resources for some tasks.

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Accessibility

Text-to-speech, translation, and simplification tools can make dense readings or lectures usable for students with disabilities or language barriers.

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Frees You Up for Higher-Value Work

Letting AI handle rote formatting or basic research frees up your time and energy for the actual thinking, writing, and problem-solving that build your skills.

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Faster Iteration

AI can help you generate a rough first draft or extra practice problems quickly, so you spend your time revising and improving instead of staring at a blank page.

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Data-Driven Insight

AI can help you make sense of a big pile of lecture notes or readings, turning them into something organized you can actually study from.

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